Smartious
HOMESCHOOL · GLOBAL
EST. 2018

Admission Pack

2026–27 academic year · Effective 15 October 2026

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Lessons begin only after Smartious has received the signed Admission Agreement (Part 2) and the first term’s fees.

PART 1 · WELCOME AND INFORMATION

1 Welcome from the Principal

Dear parents, guardians and students,

Thank you for choosing Smartious. Whether your child is joining our online school, learning at home with us, or taking one-to-one tuition, you are joining a school that has taught families across Kenya and more than 40 countries since 2018.

Our promise is simple: qualified teachers who know your child, small live classes, honest feedback and records you can trust. Every grade we give reflects what your child has truly achieved, and no record is ever changed for any favour. That is what makes a Smartious report and a Smartious reference worth something to universities and employers.

This pack tells you how admission works, what to prepare, and what we expect of each other. Part 2 is the agreement that the student and a parent or guardian sign before lessons begin. Please read it with your child, and contact us with any question.

We look forward to teaching your child.

The Principal
Smartious E-School Ltd

2 About Smartious

Smartious E-School Ltd is an international online and home-based school founded in Nairobi in 2018. We teach the Cambridge, Pearson Edexcel, IB and American curricula, the Kenyan CBC, and the Ontario Secondary School Diploma (OSSD) through our partnership with Canadian Cross International School.

Lessons are taught live by qualified subject specialists, in small groups or one to one, at times that suit each family’s time zone. Our learning platform brings lessons, homework, assessments, reports and invoices together in one place for students and parents.

3 Programmes and curricula

Programme	What it includes
Online school and homeschool	Full-time live classes in small groups of 4–6 students, every subject in the chosen curriculum, homework and assessments, recorded lessons for review, the Mshauri AI tutor, termly reports and university guidance.
One-to-one tuition	Live online sessions with a subject specialist in any subject, at any level, scheduled to your time zone.
Curricula	Cambridge Primary, Lower Secondary, IGCSE and A-Level · Pearson Edexcel IGCSE and A-Level · IB · American curriculum and AP · Kenyan CBC · Ontario OSSD.
Languages	French, Spanish, German, Mandarin Chinese, Arabic, Kiswahili, Italian and Portuguese.

4 How admission works

1	**Apply** Complete the online application or contact our admissions team. We arrange a free consultation call.
2	**Assessment** Your child sits a placement assessment so we can place them at the right level and plan support.
3	**Learning plan and timetable** We agree the programme, subjects and any support with you, and create the timetable.
4	**Sign and pay** The student and a parent sign the Admission Agreement (Part 2) and pay the first term's fees.
5	**Orientation and first lesson** We set up portal accounts, run a short orientation, and lessons begin.

> Fees become non-refundable once the assessment is done, the timetable is created and lessons have started.

5 Documents to submit

Please send these with the signed agreement, by email to hello@smartioushomeschool.com or through the parent portal. Tick each one as you include it.

- ☐ Signed Admission Agreement (Part 2 of this pack)
- ☐ Copy of the student's passport or birth certificate
- ☐ One recent passport-size photograph of the student
- ☐ The student's most recent school report
- ☐ Copies of any examination certificates already achieved (for example IGCSE results)
- ☐ Any assessment or specialist reports about learning needs (educational psychologist, therapist, doctor), if you have them
- ☐ Proof of payment of the first term's fees

6 Fees and payment

Online school and homeschool: **USD 423 per month** for every year group and curriculum, paid termly in advance. One-to-one tuition: **USD 15 per hour**. External examination fees are separate and charged at the examination board's rate. Sibling discounts and need-based bursaries may be available; ask our admissions team in confidence.

Payments are made through Paystack: M-Pesa, Visa, Mastercard, bank transfer or Apple Pay. The full payment terms are in Section C and the Terms of Service in Part 2.

7 Academic calendar 2026–27

Term	Dates	Half-term	Notes
Term 1	25 August – 4 December 2026	12–16 October 2026	Teacher training week 17–21 August
Term 2	5 January – 25 March 2027	15–19 February 2027	Mock examinations
Term 3	13 April – early July 2027	Late May 2027	External examinations (provisional)

Students can join at any point in the year. Examination entry deadlines are set by each board; we will tell you yours.

8 Getting ready for online learning

- A laptop or desktop computer is best; a tablet works for most lessons. A camera and microphone are needed for live lessons, and a headset helps.
- A reliable internet connection, and a backup such as mobile data for exam days.
- A quiet, well-lit place to learn, where a parent or guardian is nearby for younger students.
- Exercise books, a scientific calculator for secondary maths and science, and the textbooks your teacher lists.
- Your student and parent portal logins, which we send after admission. Keep them private.

9 Reports, examinations and university guidance

- Parents can follow attendance, homework, marks and invoices in the parent portal.
- Written progress reports every term, with grades, and a parent–teacher consultation each term.
- We enter students for Cambridge, Pearson Edexcel, IB and College Board examinations and guide families through entry deadlines and access arrangements.
- University and careers guidance from Year 10, including UCAS, Common App and applications worldwide.

10 Expectations in lessons

- Join on time, with camera on unless your teacher says otherwise, and be ready to take part.
- Dress and behave as you would in a classroom, and choose a suitable background.
- Be kind and respectful to teachers and classmates, in lessons and in the student community.
- Do your own work, and use AI only as the AI Use Policy allows.
- Do not record, share or post lessons or teaching materials.
- If you miss a lesson, watch the recording and catch up on the work.

11 Who to contact

Admissions, fees and general questions	hello@smartioushomeschool.com · +254 745 021 212
Safeguarding concerns	safeguarding@smartioushomeschool.com · +254 745 021 212
Office and website	Diamond Plaza I, Parklands, Nairobi, Kenya · smartioushomeschool.com

PART 2 · ADMISSION AGREEMENT

Admission Agreement

Complete, sign and return before the first lesson

1. Complete Sections A and B with the student's and parent's details.

2. Read the fees (Section C) and every policy in Section D. They are also published at smartioushomeschool.com.

3. Tick the consents in Section E.

4. The **student** and a **parent or legal guardian** sign the declarations in Section F. Students aged 18 or over who pay their own fees sign both.

5. Return the signed agreement with the documents in item 5 of Part 1 to **hello@smartioushomeschool.com** or upload it in the parent portal.

You can fill in the fields on screen and sign electronically, or print the pages and sign by hand. Please keep a copy for your records.

Section A · Student details

STUDENT FULL NAME (AS ON PASSPORT OR BIRTH CERTIFICATE)

DATE OF BIRTH

NATIONALITY

COUNTRY OF RESIDENCE

TIME ZONE

STUDENT EMAIL

STUDENT PHONE / WHATSAPP

CURRICULUM

YEAR / GRADE JOINING

INTENDED START DATE

PROGRAMME (ONLINE SCHOOL, HOMESCHOOL, 1-ON-1 TUITION)

SUBJECTS

PREVIOUS SCHOOL AND LAST YEAR COMPLETED

LANGUAGES SPOKEN AT HOME

FIRST LANGUAGE

Learning needs, disabilities, health or medical information we should know to keep the student safe and support them well (see the Inclusion Policy). This information is kept confidential.

LEARNING NEEDS AND SUPPORT

MEDICAL CONDITIONS, ALLERGIES, MEDICATION

Section B · Parent or guardian details

Parent / guardian 1

FULL NAME

RELATIONSHIP TO STUDENT

EMAIL

PHONE / WHATSAPP

HOME ADDRESS

Parent / guardian 2 (optional)

FULL NAME

RELATIONSHIP TO STUDENT

EMAIL

PHONE / WHATSAPP

HOME ADDRESS

Fee payer and emergency contact

PERSON RESPONSIBLE FOR FEES

INVOICE EMAIL

EMERGENCY CONTACT NAME

RELATIONSHIP

PHONE

Section C · Fees and payment terms

Programme	Fee	Billing
Online school and homeschool, every year group and curriculum	USD 423 per month	Paid termly, in advance
One-to-one tuition, any subject, any level	USD 15 per hour	As booked
External examination fees (Cambridge, Pearson Edexcel, IB, College Board)	Board rate	Separate, before entry

Refunds. Fees are non-refundable once the student's assessment has been done, the timetable has been created and lessons have started. This applies to the whole term paid for. Before that point, tuition paid in advance is refunded, less the application fee once the assessment has been served. To withdraw at the end of a term, tell Smartious in writing before the next term's invoice is due.

All fees are stated in US Dollars; local currency amounts are shown for convenience only. Payments are made through Paystack (M-Pesa, Visa, Mastercard, bank transfer, Apple Pay). Full terms are in the Terms of Service in Section D.

Section D · Policies

These are the policies in force on the date of signing. They are the same as the versions published on our website. By signing Section F you confirm that you have read them.

Terms of Service

Published at smartioushomeschool.com/terms

1. About these terms

These Terms of Service ("Terms") govern your use of smartioushomeschool.com and any educational services provided by Smartious E-School Ltd ("Smartious"). By enrolling a student, creating an account, or using any part of our website or services, you agree to these Terms. If you do not agree, please do not use our services.

2. Eligibility

To enrol a student, you must be the student's parent or legal guardian and at least 18 years old. Students under 18 cannot create an account without parental consent. We reserve the right to verify identity at any stage, particularly before releasing academic records or issuing predicted grades.

3. Enrolment and assessment

Enrolment begins when you submit the enrolment form and pay the USD 38 (KSh 5,000) application fee. The assessment fee is non-refundable once the placement test has been served, but counts towards your first month of tuition if you proceed to enrol. We aim to match a tutor within 48 working hours of a completed assessment.

4. Fees and payment

All fees are stated in US Dollars. Local currency equivalents (e.g. KES for Kenyan families) are shown for convenience but the dollar price is the contractual amount. Online school and homeschool programmes are USD 423 per month for every year group and curriculum, payable termly in advance. One-to-one tuition is USD 15 per hour. Examination board fees are separate. Payments are processed via Paystack. We accept M-Pesa, Visa, Mastercard, bank transfer, and Apple Pay.

5. Cancellation and refunds

Fees are non-refundable once the student's assessment has been done, the timetable has been created and lessons have started. This applies to the whole term paid for. If you cancel in writing before that point, we refund tuition paid in advance, less the application fee once the assessment has been served. To withdraw at the end of a term, tell us in writing before the next term's invoice is due; no further fees will then be charged.

6. Your obligations

You agree to: (i) provide accurate information when enrolling; (ii) ensure your child attends scheduled lessons or gives reasonable notice for cancellations; (iii) provide a safe, supervised environment for home-visit tuition in Nairobi; (iv) treat Smartious staff, tutors, and our digital platforms with respect; (v) not share your portal login credentials with anyone outside your household; (vi) not record, reproduce, or redistribute our teaching materials or live lessons without written permission.

7. Our obligations

Smartious will: (i) deliver lessons, materials, and assessments as described in your enrolment package; (ii) provide qualified, background-checked tutors; (iii) keep academic records for at least 7 years; (iv) issue progress reports as specified in your plan; (v) communicate any material changes at least 30 days in advance; (vi) act in the student's best academic interests at all times.

8. Intellectual property

All content published by Smartious, teaching materials, lesson recordings, assessment banks, software, the Mshauri AI tutor, and the website itself, is the intellectual property of Smartious E-School Ltd or our licensors. You may use this content only within your own household for the enrolled student's education. Commercial use, redistribution, or resale is strictly prohibited and may result in termination of services and legal action. Past papers and marking schemes are the property of their respective exam boards (Cambridge, Edexcel, IB) and are reproduced under licence or fair-dealing provisions.

9. Tutor availability and substitution

We strive to match each student to the same dedicated tutor for the duration of enrolment. Where a tutor becomes unavailable (illness, relocation, resignation), we will provide a qualified substitute and notify you as soon as reasonably possible. Temporary substitutions do not change the fees; if we cannot provide a qualified tutor for an extended period, we will rematch your child or credit the missed lessons to the next term.

10. Code of conduct

We reserve the right to suspend or terminate services, without refund, if a parent or student engages in abusive, discriminatory, or harassing behaviour towards our staff or tutors; attempts to defraud or deceive Smartious; or repeatedly breaches these Terms after written warning. This is rare, but necessary to protect our team.

11. Limitation of liability

To the maximum extent permitted by Kenyan law, Smartious is not liable for: (i) exam results or university admissions: our role is to teach and prepare; outcomes depend on many factors including the student's effort and the decisions of exam boards and universities; (ii) indirect, consequential, or punitive damages; (iii) delays or outages caused by third-party services (Paystack, Google, Netlify). Our total liability for any claim is limited to the fees you have paid us in the 12 months preceding the claim.

12. Governing law

These Terms are governed by the laws of Kenya. Any dispute arising from these Terms or our services will be resolved first by good-faith negotiation, then by mediation in Nairobi under the Mediation (Court-Annexed) Rules, and only then by the courts of Kenya, which have exclusive jurisdiction.

13. Changes to these terms

We may update these Terms from time to time. Material changes will be communicated to active students and parents at least 30 days in advance by email. Minor clarifications (typos, reformatting) may be made without notice. The current version is always published here with its effective date.

14. Contact

Questions about these Terms: hello@smartioushomeschool.com, +254 745 021 212, or Diamond Plaza I, Parklands, Nairobi, Kenya.

Academic Integrity Policy

Published at smartioushomeschool.com/academic-integrity

1. Our commitment

Every grade, report and certificate Smartious issues must tell the truth about what a student has learned and achieved. Universities, exam boards, employers and families rely on our records, and so do our students. This policy sets out the standards of honesty we expect from students, parents and staff, and how we protect the integrity of every record we keep.

2. Records are never modified for any favour

No student record will be changed in any way, for any reason, in return for any favour. This covers marks, grades, predicted grades, attendance, reports, transcripts, references, certificates and examination entries. It applies whatever is offered or asked: money, gifts, discounts, extra fees, personal favours, friendship, family connections, promises, pressure or threats, and whoever offers it, whether a parent, a student, a member of staff or anyone else. There are no exceptions, and no member of staff, including the Principal, has the authority to make one.

3. Offering a favour is itself a breach

Offering, promising or giving anything to influence a record is a serious breach of this policy, whether or not the offer is accepted. Staff must refuse any such offer, record it, and report it to the Principal and to Quality Assurance on the same day. A member of staff who accepts an offer, or changes a record improperly, will be dismissed. A family or student who makes an offer may have their enrolment ended, and the matter may be reported to the relevant examination board or authority.

4. How a genuine error is corrected

Records stay as they were issued. If a student or parent believes a record contains a genuine clerical error, such as a mark entered against the wrong student, they may raise it in writing with Quality Assurance. If evidence proves the error, the original entry is kept exactly as it was, and the corrected entry is added beside it, dated, with the reason and the names of the people who approved it. The original is never deleted or overwritten. A correction never changes a teacher’s academic judgement; disagreement with a mark is handled through the appeals process below.

5. Appeals against a mark

A student who disagrees with a mark may appeal within 14 days of receiving it, asking for the work to be reviewed by a second qualified teacher who did not mark it. The reviewer’s decision and reasons are recorded. If the review changes the mark, the original mark is kept and the corrected mark is added beside it. For external examinations, appeals follow the rules of the examination board (Cambridge, Pearson Edexcel, IB or College Board), and Smartious will support the family through that process.

6. What we expect of students

Students submit their own work. That means no copying from another student or a source without acknowledging it, no buying or commissioning work, no sharing answers during assessments, no impersonation in online lessons or exams, and no use of unauthorised materials or tools, including AI tools where they are not allowed (see our AI Use Policy). Students acknowledge every source they use, in the way their teacher shows them.

7. What we expect of parents

Parents support honest work at home. Helping a child understand a topic is welcome; completing assessed work for them is not. During online assessments, parents make sure the student works alone and without unauthorised help or materials, and never ask a teacher to change, inflate or predict a grade beyond the evidence.

8. What we expect of staff

Teachers mark fairly against the published mark scheme and predict grades only on evidence. Staff never share assessment content in advance, never complete work for a student, and never change a record outside the correction process above. Any member of staff who is asked to do so must report it.

9. External examinations

Cambridge, Pearson Edexcel, IB and College Board each have rules on malpractice. Smartious follows them in full and reports suspected malpractice in external examinations to the board concerned, as the boards require. A finding of malpractice by a board can lead to the loss of a grade or of a whole qualification.

10. How suspected misconduct is handled

Suspected misconduct is investigated by a member of staff who is not the student's teacher. The student and parent are told what is suspected and are given the chance to respond before any decision is made. Outcomes depend on the seriousness of the case and range from redoing the work under supervision, to a mark of zero for the piece of work, to suspension or ending enrolment. Every decision and its reasons are recorded.

11. Reporting a concern

Anyone who is offered a favour, sees a record changed improperly, or suspects misconduct should tell the Principal or Quality Assurance at once by email at hello@smartioushomeschool.com or by phone on +254 745 021 212. Reports can be made in confidence, and no one will be treated unfairly for raising a concern in good faith.

12. Review

This policy is reviewed at least once every 12 months, and whenever examination board rules change.

AI Use Policy

Published at smartioushomeschool.com/ai-policy

1. Why we have this policy

Artificial intelligence can help students learn, and it can also be misused to avoid learning. This policy explains how Smartious uses AI, when students may and may not use it, and how we protect students' data and the honesty of their work.

2. How Smartious uses AI

Our Mshauri AI tutor helps students between live lessons: it explains ideas, gives hints and helps students practise. It is a study aid, not a teacher, and it does not replace the qualified teachers who plan lessons, mark work and make every academic decision. Teachers may use AI tools to help prepare materials; they check everything before it reaches a student.

3. AI never decides a student's grade

Every mark, grade, report and predicted grade is decided by a qualified teacher. AI may help to check spelling or suggest feedback, but it never decides an outcome for a student.

4. When students may use AI

Students may use AI to understand a topic, to get hints while practising, to check their own understanding, and to revise, unless their teacher says otherwise for a particular task. Students should always think through the answer for themselves rather than copy what an AI tool produces.

5. When students may not use AI

Students must not use AI to produce work that they submit as their own, to answer questions in tests, quizzes or examinations, or in any assessed work or coursework, unless the teacher has clearly allowed it for that task. Cambridge, Pearson Edexcel, IB and College Board treat undeclared AI-generated work in assessed tasks as malpractice, and so do we.

6. Saying when AI was used

When AI use is allowed in a task, students say which tool they used and how, in the way their teacher shows them. Work that hides AI use is treated as a breach of our Academic Integrity Policy.

7. How we check work

Teachers know their students' work and may ask a student to explain or redo a piece of work in a live lesson. We do not decide that work is AI-generated on the basis of a detection tool alone, because these tools can be wrong. Any concern is handled under the Academic Integrity Policy, and the student is always given the chance to respond.

8. Protecting students' data

We share no more student information with an AI service than a task needs, and we never sell student data. Students must not enter personal details, such as their full name, address, phone number or photographs, into AI tools. Our use of AI services follows our Privacy Policy.

9. Safe use

AI tools can be wrong, biased or unsuitable for children. Students should check important facts with their teacher or a trusted source, and tell a teacher or parent if an AI tool shows them anything that worries them. Concerns about a child's safety are handled under our Child Protection and Safeguarding Policy.

10. Parents

We encourage parents to talk with their children about using AI honestly and safely, and to contact us with any question about how AI is used in their child's learning.

11. Review

AI changes quickly. We review this policy at least once every 12 months, and sooner when examination boards update their guidance.

Inclusion Policy

Published at smartioushomeschool.com/inclusion-policy

1. Our commitment

Smartious welcomes every learner. We believe each child can make real progress when teaching fits how they learn, and our small classes and one-to-one lessons let us adapt to each student. This policy explains how we include and support students with different needs, backgrounds and abilities.

2. Equal treatment

We do not discriminate on the grounds of race, ethnicity, nationality, religion or belief, sex, disability, health, family background or income. Every student has the same right to respect, to a safe place to learn, and to the full curriculum.

3. Learning differences and special educational needs

We support students with learning differences such as dyslexia, dyscalculia, ADHD and autism, as well as students with physical, sensory or health needs. Parents are asked to tell us about any need at enrolment so we can plan from the first lesson; a diagnosis is helpful but not required for us to start supporting a child.

4. How we plan support

After the assessment, we agree a learning plan with the family. It sets out the student's strengths, needs, the adjustments we will make, such as pace, lesson length, breaks, recorded lessons, visual materials or one-to-one time, and how progress will be measured. Teachers follow the plan, and we review it with the family every term.

5. Access arrangements in examinations

Students who need extra time, a reader, a scribe or other arrangements in external examinations may be eligible under the rules of Cambridge, Pearson Edexcel, IB or College Board. These arrangements need evidence and must be applied for well before the exam. We guide families through the evidence each board requires and apply on the student's behalf where we are the examination centre or work with one.

6. Students who need more challenge

Able and gifted students are given work that stretches them, including faster progression, enrichment and early examination entry where it is in the student's interest.

7. Students learning in English as an additional language

Students who are still developing their English receive support so they can access the full curriculum, as set out in our Language Policy.

8. Wellbeing

Feeling safe and valued is part of learning. Teachers watch for signs that a student is struggling, and we work with families when a student needs extra care. Bullying, exclusion and unkind language are not tolerated in lessons or in our student community.

9. Financial access

We want a Smartious education to be within reach of families who value it. Sibling discounts and need-based bursaries may be available; families can ask our admissions team in confidence.

10. Accessible platforms

Our portals and live lessons are designed to work on phones, tablets and computers. Families who have difficulty using our platforms because of a disability can ask us for an alternative, and we will do what we reasonably can to help.

11. Working with families and specialists

Parents know their children best. With the family's consent, we are happy to work with therapists, educational psychologists and other specialists who support the student.

12. Concerns and review

If you feel a student's needs are not being met, contact us at hello@smartioushomeschool.com or +254 745 021 212 and we will respond within five working days. We review this policy at least once every 12 months.

Language Policy

Published at smartioushomeschool.com/language-policy

1. Purpose

Language is how students learn, think and connect with others. This policy sets out the language we teach in, how we support students who are learning English, and how we value the many languages our families speak.

2. Language of instruction

English is the language of instruction and assessment for all our programmes, except in language lessons and where a curriculum requires another language, such as Kiswahili within the Kenyan CBC.

3. Every teacher supports language

All teachers help students build the language of their subject: the vocabulary of science, the structure of an argument in history, and the precise wording examiners expect. Clear written and spoken English is part of every lesson.

4. English as an additional language

Students whose first language is not English are assessed when they join, and receive support matched to their level. This can include extra one-to-one sessions, glossaries of key terms, adapted materials and more time to process instructions. Support continues until the student can access the full curriculum independently, and progress is reviewed every term.

5. Home languages are valued

A student's home language is a strength. Students are encouraged to keep reading, speaking and writing in it, and may use it to make sense of new ideas. Families are encouraged to keep using their home language at home.

6. Modern foreign languages

Smartious teaches French, Spanish, German, Mandarin Chinese, Arabic, Kiswahili, Italian and Portuguese, including preparation for IGCSE, A-Level and IB examinations. Language lessons are taught mainly in the target language.

7. Communication with families

We communicate with families in English. Where a parent is more comfortable in another language, we will try to help, for example by using simpler English, meeting by video, or finding a member of staff who speaks the language.

8. Respectful language

Language in lessons, messages and the student community must be respectful. Offensive, discriminatory or bullying language is not accepted, in any language, and is handled under our code of conduct and Child Protection and Safeguarding Policy.

9. Review

We review this policy at least once every 12 months.

Child Protection & Safeguarding Policy

Published at smartioushomeschool.com/child-protection

1. Our commitment

Smartious E-School Ltd teaches children every day, in their homes and online, across many countries. Their safety comes before everything else we do. This Child Protection and Safeguarding Policy sets out how we keep every student safe, what we expect of our staff and tutors, and how anyone can raise a concern. It applies to every person who works with or on behalf of Smartious, whether teaching in person in Nairobi or online anywhere in the world.

2. Who this protects

This policy protects every student under the age of 18, and any student aged 18 or over who is considered a vulnerable adult. Because our classrooms are often virtual and our families are spread across continents, we hold ourselves to the safeguarding standards of the strongest jurisdictions we serve, including Kenya, the United Kingdom and the United Arab Emirates, rather than the weakest.

3. Safer recruitment

Every tutor and member of staff is interviewed in person or by video, provides references that we contact directly, and confirms their identity and qualifications before they ever meet a child. Where the law of a tutor's country allows it, we require a criminal record check such as a Kenyan Police Clearance Certificate or an equivalent background check. No adult works unsupervised with a child until these checks are complete.

4. Safe online teaching

Our live classes and one to one lessons follow clear rules that protect both the child and the teacher. Lessons happen on Smartious platforms, never on a tutor's personal account. Tutors do not contact students through personal phone numbers, personal email, or private social media. A parent is always able to see the schedule and join a lesson. Group lessons and recordings are logged. These rules exist so that every interaction is visible and accountable.

5. The student community

Our student community space is one monitored room for the whole school. It is designed for safety by default: there are no private messages between students, students cannot create hidden groups, and teachers are present and visible. Every message passes an automatic filter that blocks the sharing of phone numbers, email addresses, links and social media handles, so that no one can move a child off our safe platform. Any student or teacher can report a message, and repeated reports hide it automatically until a moderator reviews it. Removed messages are kept on record. Teachers and administrators moderate the space every day.

6. What we consider abuse

We take seriously every form of harm to a child: physical abuse, emotional abuse, sexual abuse, neglect, bullying and online harms such as grooming, harassment and exposure to harmful content. Our staff are trained to recognise the signs, to take any disclosure seriously, and never to promise a child that they will keep a safeguarding concern secret.

7. How to raise a concern

If you are worried about the safety of any child connected to Smartious, tell us at once. Email our Designated Safeguarding Lead at safeguarding@smartioushomeschool.com or call +254 745 021 212 and ask for the safeguarding lead. If a child is in immediate danger, contact your local emergency services first, then tell us. Concerns can be raised by a parent, a student, a member of staff, or a member of the public. You do not need proof to raise a concern; a genuine worry is enough.

8. How we respond

Every concern is recorded and reviewed by our Designated Safeguarding Lead within one working day, and urgent concerns immediately. We act in the best interests of the child at all times. Where we believe a child is at risk of harm, we will report to the relevant authorities, which may include the Directorate of Children's Services in Kenya or the equivalent child protection agency in the child's country. We cooperate fully with any investigation.

9. Staff conduct and training

Every member of staff agrees to a code of conduct that governs how they communicate with children, maintains professional boundaries, and requires them to report any concern. Safeguarding is part of induction for every new tutor, and we refresh this training regularly. A member of staff who breaches this policy faces disciplinary action up to and including dismissal and referral to the authorities.

10. Working with parents

Parents are our partners in safeguarding. The parent is the primary account holder, sees the lesson schedule, and can raise a concern at any time. We encourage families to talk with their children about online safety, to know who is teaching their child, and to contact us the moment anything feels wrong.

11. Our safeguarding lead

Our Designated Safeguarding Lead is responsible for handling concerns, keeping records, liaising with authorities, and reviewing this policy. Reach the safeguarding lead at safeguarding@smartioushomeschool.com or +254 745 021 212. In the lead's absence, the Founder, Alfred Ouko, acts as deputy.

12. Review

We review this policy at least once every 12 months, and immediately after any safeguarding incident or any change in the law of the countries we serve. This page shows the date it was last reviewed. Keeping children safe is never finished, and we improve our practice continuously.

Privacy Policy

Published at smartioushomeschool.com/privacy

1. Who we are

Smartious E-School Ltd ("Smartious", "we", "us", "our") is a private limited company registered in Kenya, with its principal place of business at Diamond Plaza I, Parklands, Nairobi. We operate the website smartioushomeschool.com and deliver homeschool, online and private tuition services to students worldwide. For the purposes of Kenya's Data Protection Act, 2019 and the EU General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR), Smartious is the Data Controller of the personal data you share with us.

2. What personal data we collect

We collect only the data we genuinely need to deliver education and communicate with families. This includes: (a) contact and identification data: student and parent names, email addresses, WhatsApp numbers, student date of birth, country of residence; (b) academic data: curriculum selection, current school, grade level, placement assessment answers and scores, progress reports; (c) payment data: we do not store full card numbers; Paystack processes all payments and we receive only the transaction reference and amount; (d) technical data: IP address, browser type, device type, pages visited, collected via cookies and analytics; (e) communication records: messages you send us by email, WhatsApp, contact form, or during consultation calls.

3. How we use your data

We use personal data only for: (i) delivering the programme you have enrolled in, matching tutors, scheduling lessons, issuing progress reports, sitting exams; (ii) communicating with you about your account, lessons, payments, and service updates; (iii) processing payments via Paystack; (iv) improving our website and teaching methods through anonymised analytics; (v) complying with Kenyan tax, education, and regulatory obligations. We do not sell personal data to third parties. Ever.

4. Lawful basis for processing

Under Article 6 of the GDPR and Section 30 of the Kenya Data Protection Act, we process your data on one of the following lawful bases: (a) Contract: to deliver the services you have enrolled in; (b) Consent: for marketing communications, which you can withdraw at any time; (c) Legitimate interests: for securing our systems, preventing fraud, and improving our services; (d) Legal obligation: for tax records, accounting, and regulatory compliance.

5. Who we share your data with

We share data only with parties essential to service delivery: (i) our assigned tutors and assessment teachers, who see only the data needed to teach your child; (ii) Paystack (Paystack Payments Limited, Lagos & Nairobi) for payment processing; (iii) Google (Firebase, Gmail, Drive) for our backend infrastructure, subject to Google's Cloud Data Processing Addendum; (iv) FormSubmit.co for form delivery; (v) MongoDB Atlas for database hosting; (vi) Netlify and Render for website and API hosting. All processors are bound by data processing agreements. We require them to meet or exceed our own data protection standards.

6. International transfers

Some of our processors (Google, MongoDB Atlas, Netlify, Render) store data in the US or EU. Where data is transferred outside Kenya or the European Economic Area, we rely on appropriate safeguards, Standard Contractual Clauses approved by the European Commission, or equivalent mechanisms under the Kenya DPA, to ensure your data receives equivalent protection.

7. How long we keep your data

We keep data only as long as needed: (a) active student records: for the duration of enrolment plus 7 years after the last lesson, to comply with Kenyan tax law and academic record-keeping standards; (b) enquiry and consultation records: 24 months from last contact; (c) marketing subscribers: until you unsubscribe; (d) website analytics: 26 months (Google Analytics default). After these periods, data is securely deleted or anonymised.

8. Your rights

Both the Kenya Data Protection Act and the GDPR give you the following rights: (i) Access: request a copy of all personal data we hold about you; (ii) Rectification: correct inaccurate data; (iii) Erasure: request deletion of your data, subject to our legal retention obligations; (iv) Restriction: limit how we process your data; (v) Portability: receive your data in a machine-readable format; (vi) Objection: object to specific types of processing, especially marketing; (vii) Withdraw consent at any time. To exercise any right, email hello@smartioushomeschool.com. We respond within 30 days as required by law.

9. Data of minors

Because many of our students are under 18, parental consent is required before any child is enrolled or assessed. The parent is the primary account holder and the primary contact. We do not knowingly collect personal data directly from children under 13 without parental involvement. If you believe we have done so inadvertently, contact us and we will delete the data immediately.

10. Security

We use industry-standard safeguards: HTTPS (TLS 1.3) across the entire site, password hashing (bcrypt) for all accounts, role-based access control in our backend, encrypted database backups, and quarterly security reviews. Paystack handles payment data to PCI-DSS Level 1 standards, we never see or store full card details. No system is perfectly secure, but we work continuously to reduce risk.

11. Breach notification

In the unlikely event of a personal data breach affecting your rights, we will notify the Office of the Data Protection Commissioner (Kenya) within 72 hours as required by Section 43 of the Kenya DPA, and the affected individuals without undue delay, describing what happened, what data was affected, and the steps we are taking.

12. Changes to this policy

We may update this policy to reflect changes in law, our services, or our processors. When we make material changes we will notify active students and parents by email and update the "Effective" date at the top of this page. The most current version is always the one published here.

13. Contact & complaints

For any privacy question, data subject request, or complaint, email our Data Protection point of contact: hello@smartioushomeschool.com, phone +254 745 021 212, or write to Smartious E-School Ltd, Diamond Plaza I, Parklands, Nairobi, Kenya. You also have the right to lodge a complaint with the Office of the Data Protection Commissioner of Kenya (odpc.go.ke) or, if you are in the EU, with your national data protection authority.

Section E · Consents

Please tick each box you agree to. Consents marked **required** are needed for the student to learn with Smartious.

- ☐ **Required.** Smartious may process the student's and parents' personal data to provide education, as set out in the Privacy Policy.
- ☐ **Required.** Live lessons may be recorded so students can review them and for safeguarding, as set out in the Child Protection and Privacy policies.
- ☐ **Required.** Smartious may share the student's details with examination boards and examination centres to enter the student for external examinations.
- ☐ Smartious may contact me by email, phone and WhatsApp about the student's learning, fees and school news.
- ☐ Smartious may use the student's first name, photographs or work on its website and social media. (Optional: you may withdraw this at any time.)
- ☐ The student may use the Mshauri AI tutor under the AI Use Policy.

Section F · Declarations and signatures

Student declaration

- ☐ I will do my own work and acknowledge every source I use.
- ☐ I will not copy, buy or share answers, and I will not use AI tools in tests or assessed work unless my teacher allows it, and I will say when I have used them.
- ☐ I understand that my marks, grades, reports and certificates will never be changed for any favour, gift, payment or pressure, from anyone, and that offering one is a serious breach.
- ☐ I will treat teachers and other students with respect, online and in lessons, and follow the Child Protection rules for safe online learning.
- ☐ I have read, or had explained to me, the Academic Integrity, AI Use, Language and Inclusion policies.

STUDENT

Signature _____ Full name _____ Date _____

Parent or guardian declaration

- ☐ The information in this agreement is complete and accurate, and I will tell Smartious promptly if it changes.
- ☐ I accept the fees in Section C: USD 423 per month, paid termly in advance, and USD 15 per hour for one-to-one tuition.
- ☐ I understand that fees are non-refundable once the assessment has been done, the timetable has been created and lessons have started.
- ☐ I understand that no student record will be changed in any way, for any reason, in return for any favour, and that offering a favour may end the enrolment.
- ☐ I have read and agree to the Terms of Service and the policies in Section D, and I will support my child to follow them.

PARENT OR GUARDIAN

Signature _____ Full name _____ Date _____

FOR SMARTIOUS USE ONLY

ADMISSION NUMBER	RECEIVED BY	DATE RECEIVED

ASSESSMENT DATE	TIMETABLE CREATED ON	FIRST LESSON DATE

ADMISSIONS, FOR SMARTIOUS

Signature _____ Full name _____ Date _____